



COWORK OS GUIDE

# Working Alongside

**Notion, Drive, Office & the rest of your stack**

*CoWork OS doesn't replace the tools you already use. Here's how I think about Notion and CoWork running side by side — and how to fit your other tools in too.*

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# Do I replace Notion with CoWork? Or run them together?

— Simon, on how I actually use both

The short answer: **together**. Notion and CoWork OS do different jobs. They overlap a little, but the value comes from running both in their lanes.

This is the mental model I actually use day to day. Notion is where my work lives and where my team and I collaborate. CoWork OS is where I actually create, think, and make strategic moves with Claude alongside me. Same person, two different working modes.

## NOTION

### Where work lives

Notion is where things get organised, shared, and visualised. Pages, databases, shared views — the interface my team and I open to see what matters at a glance and reference it on demand.

- Content database, CRM, tasks, projects, knowledge hub
- Shared views and team collaboration
- Reference material I want to pull up quickly
- **Notion's Personal Agent** — the quick way to collaborate with all the expertise Notion already has about my workspace

## COWORK OS

### Where creation happens

CoWork OS is where creation, thinking, and strategy happen. The place I work things out with Claude — drafts, decisions, deep thinking — with full context loaded and connectors reaching across my whole stack.

- About Me files, voice profile, writing rules, memory
- Drafts, research, generators, outputs — work I actually make
- Knowledge bases I want Claude to learn deeply
- A wider connector reach — local files plus Gmail, Drive, Slack, Calendar, and Notion itself

**One sentence:** *Notion is where work lives and teamwork happens — things get organised, shared, and visualised. CoWork is the place where creation, thinking, and strategy happen.*

# The split in practice

Here's how the two spaces actually pass work between them in my day.

## I draft and prep in CoWork OS

When I'm writing a YouTube script, putting together a deck, drafting an email sequence, or building a guide PDF, I do that in CoWork. Claude knows my voice, my writing rules, my recent decisions, the project history — all the context lives here. The output gets generated locally, in my project's `outputs/` folder.

## I publish into Notion

Once a draft is ready to be shared, I push it into Notion — the script lands in the YouTube Content database, the proposal lands in the project page, the report gets attached to the right CRM record. From there, my team can see it, comment on it, take it forward. That's a Notion job.

## I reference Notion from CoWork OS

When Claude needs context that lives in Notion — "what's the latest pricing on the Accelerator?", "what did we agree with that sponsor?", "pull the contact details for this lead" — CoWork reaches into Notion via the connector. The context map in `ABOUT ME/my-context-map.md` tells Claude which Notion databases hold what.

**The way I think about it:** *Notion is the place where things are organised, shared, and visible.  
CoWork is the place where things get made.*

## Coming soon: External agents in Notion

Notion is rolling out the ability for external agents to speak to you in the context of Notion pages — meaning your Claude agent can collaborate directly inside Notion. The same Claude you set up here in CoWork OS, with the same context, working alongside you on a Notion page instead of in a CoWork conversation. Two surfaces, one agent.

# Drive, Office, Gmail, Slack — same principle

The Notion vs CoWork model extends to everything else. Your existing tools stay where they are. CoWork OS connects to them through connectors and uses them as context sources.

## Google Drive / OneDrive / SharePoint

Where your files and documents live. CoWork reaches in to read scripts, briefs, research. Add the key folders to your context map so Claude knows where to look.

## Gmail / Outlook

Your inbox stays your inbox. Claude reads threads, drafts replies, applies labels — but never sends without you reviewing. Connect it and tell Claude in the context map which labels and threads matter.

## Google Calendar / Microsoft Calendar

Your source of truth for time. CoWork reads events for briefings and drafts new ones for you to confirm. Both Google and Microsoft equivalents work.

## Slack / Teams

Your team chat. CoWork can read channels, draft messages, summarise threads. Same principle as email — drafts wait for you. Both Slack and Microsoft Teams connectors are available.

**The rule:** *If your data lives somewhere already, leave it there. Connect CoWork to it. Tell Claude in ABOUT ME/my-context-map.md what's in each place.*

## The one thing CoWork OS does replace

It replaces the slow, manual work of explaining your context to Claude every single time. Without CoWork OS, every conversation starts from zero — you re-explain who you are, what you're working on, how you write. With CoWork OS, that context is loaded automatically and your tools are connected, so Claude can act on it.

Everything else you already have stays exactly where it is.

## COMING SOON

## The Agentic Business OS — the matching Notion template

If you'd like the same thinking applied to Notion — a template that gives you the structure, databases, and AI-ready architecture for running your business in Notion — the **Agentic Business OS** ships from Better Creating shortly. CoWork OS is the local half. Agentic Business OS is the shared half. Use both together and the model in this guide becomes the actual product.

Visit [bettercreating.com](https://bettercreating.com) for more.